THE BOOK OF

ZEPHANIAH

Jehovah's Day of Wrath coming upon Judah. The People warned to seek Jehovah

1 The word of Jehovah which came unto Zephaniah the son of Cushi, the son of Gedaliah, the son of Amariah, the son of Hezekiah, in the days of [a] Josiah the son of [b] Amon, king of Judah.

2 I will utterly [c] consume all things from off the face of the ground, saith Jehovah. 3 I will consume [d] man and beast; I will consume the [e] birds of the heavens, and the fishes of the sea, and the [f] stumblingblocks with the wicked; and I will cut off man from off the face of the ground, saith Jehovah. 4 And I will [g] stretch out my hand upon Judah, and upon all the inhabitants of Jerusalem; and I will [h] cut off the remnant of Baal from this place, *and* the name of the [i] Chemarim with the priests; 5 and them that worship the [k] host of heaven upon the housetops; and them that worship, that [l] swear to Jehovah and swear by [1 m] Malcam; 6 and them that are [n] turned back from following Jehovah; and those that have [o] not sought Jehovah, nor inquired after him.

7 [p] Hold thy peace at the presence of the Lord Jehovah; for the [q] day of Jehovah is at hand: for Jehovah hath prepared a [r] sacrifice, he hath [s] consecrated his guests. 8 And it shall come to pass in the day of Jehovah's sacrifice, that I will [2 t] punish the princes, and the king's sons, and all such as are clothed with [u] foreign apparel. 9 And in that day I will [2] punish all those that leap over the threshold, that fill their master's house with [v] violence and deceit. 10 And in that day, saith Jehovah, there shall be the noise of a [x] cry from the [y] fish gate, and a wailing from the [3 z] second quarter, and a great crashing from the [a] hills. 11 Wail, ye inhabitants of [4] Maktesh; for all [5] the people of [b] Canaan are undone; all they that were laden with [c] silver are cut off. 12 And it shall come to pass at that time, that I will [d] search Jerusalem with lamps; and I will [2] punish the men that are [6 e] settled on their lees, that [f] say in their heart, Jehovah will not do good, neither will he do evil. 13 And their wealth shall become a [g] spoil, and their houses a desolation: yea, [h] they shall build houses, but shall not inhabit them; and they shall plant vineyards, but shall not drink the wine thereof.

14 The [i] great [k] day of Jehovah is near, it is near and hasteth greatly, *even* the voice of the day of Jehovah; the mighty man [l] crieth there bitterly. 15 That day is a day of wrath, a day of [m] trouble and distress, a day of wasteness and desolation, a day of [n] darkness and gloominess, a day of clouds and thick darkness, 16 a day of the [o] trumpet and alarm, against the [p] fortified cities, and against the high [7] battlements. 17 And I will bring [q] distress upon men, that they shall walk [r] like blind men, because they have sinned against Jehovah; and their [s] blood shall be poured out as dust, and their [t] flesh as dung. 18 [u] Neither their silver nor their gold shall be able to deliver them in the day of Jehovah's wrath; but the whole land shall be [v] devoured by the fire of his jealousy: for he will [x] make an end, yea, a [8] terrible end, of all them that dwell in the land.

2 Gather yourselves together, yea, [y] gather together, O nation that hath [2] no [9] shame; 2 before the

[a] 2 K. 22. 1–23. 34; 2 Chr. 34. 1–35. 25; Jer. 1. 2; 22. 11
[b] 2 K. 21. 18–26; 2 Chr. 33. 20–25
[c] Jer. 7. 20; Ezek. 33. 27, 28
[d] Is. 6. 11, 12
[e] Jer. 4. 25; 9. 10
[f] Ezek. 7. 19; 14. 3, 4, 8
[g] Jer. 6. 12; Ezek. 6. 14
[h] Mic. 5. 13
[i] 2 K. 23. 5; Hos. 10. 5 (margins)
[k] 2 K. 23. 12; Jer. 19. 13
[l] Jer. 5. 2, 7; 7. 9, 10
[m] Jer. 49. 1
[n] Is. 1. 4
[o] Is. 9. 13
[p] Hab. 2. 20; Zech. 2. 13
[q] ver. 14
[r] Is. 34. 6; Jer. 46. 10
[s] 1 S. 16. 5; Is. 13. 3
[t] Is. 24. 21; Hab. 1. 10
[u] Is. 2. 6
[v] Jer. 5. 27; Am. 3. 10
[x] Is. 22. 5; Am. 8. 3
[y] 2 Chr. 33. 14
[z] 2 Chr. 34. 22
[a] 2 S. 5. 7; Ezek. 6. 13

[b] ch. 2. 5; Zech. 14. 21
[c] Job 27. 16, 17; Hos. 9. 6
[d] Jer. 16. 16, 17; Ezek. 9. 4–11; Am. 9. 1–3
[e] Jer. 48. 11; Am. 6. 1
[f] Ezek. 8. 12; 9. 9
[g] Jer. 15. 13; 17. 3
[h] Am. 5. 11; Mic. 6. 15
[i] Jer. 30. 7; Joel 2. 11; Mal. 4. 5
[k] ver. 7; Ezek. 7. 7, 12; 30. 3; Joel 1. 15; 3. 14

[l] Ezek. 7. 16–18
[m] Is. 22. 5
[n] Joel 2. 2, 31; Am. 5. 18–20
[o] Jer. 4. 19
[p] Is. 2. 12–15
[q] Jer. 10. 18
[r] Dt. 28. 29
[s] Ezek. 24. 7, 8
[t] Jer. 8. 2; 9. 22
[u] Ezek. 7. 19
[v] ch. 3. 8
[x] Ezek. 7. 5–7
[y] 2 Chr. 20. 4; Joel 1. 14
[z] Jer. 3. 3; 6. 15

1 Or, *their king*
2 Heb. *visit upon.*
3 Heb. *Mishneh.*
4 Or, *The mortar*
5 Or, *the merchant people*
6 Or, *thickened*
7 Or, *corner towers*
8 Or, *speedy*
9 Or, *longing*

Punishment threatened to Judah's Enemies. Woe to Jerusalem and the Nations

[a] decree bring forth, [1]*before* the day pass [b]as the chaff, before the [c]fierce anger of Jehovah come upon you, before the [d]day of Jehovah's anger come upon you. 3 [e]Seek ye Jehovah, all ye [f]meek of the earth, that have kept his ordinances; [g]seek righteousness, seek meekness: it may be ye will be [h]hid in the day of Jehovah's anger.

4 For [i]Gaza shall be forsaken, and [i]Ashkelon a desolation; they shall drive out [i]Ashdod at noonday, and [i]Ekron shall be rooted up. 5 Woe unto the inhabitants of [2]the sea-coast, the nation of the [k]Cherethites! The word of Jehovah is [l]against you, O [m]Canaan, the land of the Philistines; I will [n]destroy thee, that there shall be [o]no inhabitant. 6 And the sea-coast shall be [p]pastures, with [3]cottages for shepherds and folds for flocks. 7 And the coast shall be for the [q]remnant of the house of Judah; they shall [r]feed *their flocks* thereupon; in the houses of Ashkelon shall they lie down in the evening; for Jehovah their God will [s]visit them, and [4][t]bring back their captivity.

8 I have heard the [u]reproach of Moab, and the [v]revilings of the children of Ammon, wherewith they have reproached my people, and [x]magnified themselves against their border. 9 Therefore as I live, saith Jehovah of hosts, the God of Israel, Surely [y]Moab shall be as Sodom, and the children of [z]Ammon as [a]Gomorrah, a possession of [5]nettles, and saltpits, and a perpetual desolation: the residue of my people shall [b]make a prey of them, and the remnant of my nation shall inherit them. 10 This shall they have for their [c]pride, because they have [d]reproached and magnified themselves against the people of Jehovah of hosts. 11 Jehovah will be [e]terrible unto them; for he will famish all the [f]gods of the earth; and [g]men shall worship him, every one from his place, even all the [6][h]isles of the nations.

12 Ye [i]Ethiopians also, ye shall be slain by my sword. 13 And he will [k]stretch out his hand against the north, and destroy [l]Assyria, and will make [m]Nineveh a desolation, and dry like the wilderness.

[a] ch. 3. 8; 2 K. 23. 27
[b] Is. 17. 13; Hos. 13. 3
[c] Lam. 4. 11; Nah. 1. 6
[d] ch. 1. 18
[e] Ps. 105. 4; Am. 5. 6
[f] Ps. 22. 26; Is. 11. 4
[g] Am. 5. 14, 15
[h] Ps. 57. 1; Is. 26. 20
[i] Am. 1. 7, 8; Zech. 9. 5-7
[k] Ezek. 25. 16
[l] Am. 3. 1
[m] ch. 1. 11
[n] Is. 14. 29, 30
[o] ch. 3. 6
[p] Is. 7. 25
[q] Is. 11. 14; Jer. 32. 44
[r] Is. 32. 14
[s] Ex. 4. 31; Ps. 80. 14
[t] ch. 3. 20; Ps. 126. 4
[u] Ezek. 25. 8
[v] Ezek. 25. 3
[x] Am. 1. 13
[y] Is. 15. 1-16. 14; Jer. 48. 1-47; Am. 2. 1-3
[z] Jer. 49. 1-6; Ezek. 25. 1-7
[a] Dt. 29. 23
[b] Is. 11. 14
[c] Is. 16. 6
[d] ver. 8
[e] Joel 2. 11
[f] ch. 1. 4
[g] ch. 3. 9; Ps. 72. 8-11
[h] Is. 24. 15
[i] Is. 20. 4, 5; Ezek. 30. 4-9
[k] ch. 1. 4; Is. 14. 26
[l] Is. 10. 12, 16; Mic. 5. 6
[m] Nah. 3. 7
[n] Is. 14. 23; 34. 11-15
[o] Is. 22. 2
[p] Is. 32. 9, 11; 47. 8
[q] Is. 47. 8; Ezek. 28. 2, 9
[r] Is. 32. 14
[s] Jer. 18. 16; 19. 8
[t] Jer. 5. 23
[u] Ezek. 23. 30
[v] Jer. 6. 6
[x] Jer. 7. 23-28
[y] Jer. 2. 30; 5. 3
[z] Ps. 78. 22; Jer. 13. 25
[a] Ps. 73. 28
[b] Ezek. 22. 27
[c] Jer. 5. 6; Hab. 1. 8
[d] Judg. 9. 4
[e] Ezek. 22. 26; Mal. 2. 7, 8
[f] ver. 15, 17; Jer. 14. 9
[g] Dt. 32. 4
[h] Ps. 92. 15
[i] Job 7. 18

14 And herds shall lie down in the midst of her, [7]all the beasts of the nations: both the [n]pelican and the porcupine shall lodge in the capitals thereof; *their* voice shall sing in the windows; [8]desolation shall be in the thresholds: for he hath laid bare the cedar-work. 15 This is the [o]joyous city that [p]dwelt carelessly, that said in her heart, [q]I am, and there is none besides me: how is she become a [r]desolation, a place for beasts to lie down in! [s]every one that passeth by her shall hiss, and wag his hand.

3 Woe to her that is [t]rebellious and [u]polluted! to the [v]oppressing city! 2 She [x]obeyed not the voice; she [y]received not [9]correction; she [z]trusted not in Jehovah; she [a]drew not near to her God. 3 Her [b]princes in the midst of her are roaring lions; her judges are [c]evening wolves; they [10]leave nothing till the morrow. 4 Her prophets are [d]light and treacherous persons; her [e]priests have profaned the sanctuary, they have done violence to the law. 5 Jehovah [f]in the midst of her is [g]righteous; he will [h]not do iniquity; [11][i]every morning doth he bring his justice to light, he faileth not; but the unjust [k]knoweth no shame. 6 I have cut off nations; their [12][l]battlements are desolate; I have made their streets [m]waste, so that none passeth by; their [n]cities are destroyed, so that there is no man, so that there is [o]no inhabitant. 7 I said, Only fear thou me; [p]receive [9]correction; so her dwelling shall [q]not be cut off, [13]*according to* all that I have appointed concerning her: but they rose early and [r]corrupted all their doings.

8 Therefore [s]wait ye for me, saith Jehovah, until the day that I rise up to the prey; for my [14][t]determination is to [u]gather the nations, that I may assemble the kingdoms, to pour upon them mine indignation, even all my

[k] ch. 2. 1 [l] ch. 1. 16 [m] Jer. 9. 12 [n] Is. 6. 11 [o] ch. 2. 5 [p] ver. 2; Is. 63. 8 [q] Jer. 7. 7 [r] Hos. 9. 9 [s] Ps. 27. 14; Is. 30. 18; Hab. 2. 3 [t] ch. 2. 2 [u] Ezek. 38. 14-23; Joel 3. 2

[1] Or, (*the day passeth as the chaff*)
[2] Or, *the region of the sea*
[3] Or, *caves*
[4] Or, *return to*
[5] Or, *wild vetches*
[6] Or, *coast-lands*
[7] Or, *all beasts of* every *kind*
[8] Or, *drought*
[9] Or, *instruction*
[10] Or, *gnaw not the bones on the morrow*
[11] Heb. *morning by morning.*
[12] Or, *corner towers*
[13] Or, *howsoever I have punished her*
[14] Heb. *judgment.*

Restoration and Security of Israel

fierce anger; for [a] all the earth shall be devoured with the fire of my jealousy.

9 For then will I turn to the peoples a [b] pure [1] language, that they may [c] all call upon the name of Jehovah, to serve him with one [2] consent. 10 From beyond the rivers of [d] Ethiopia [3] my suppliants, even the daughter of my dispersed, shall [e] bring mine offering. 11 In that day shalt thou not be [f] put to shame for all thy doings, wherein thou hast transgressed against me; for then I will take away out of the midst of thee [4] thy [g] proudly exulting ones, and thou shalt no more be haughty in my [h] holy mountain. 12 But I will leave in the midst of thee an [i] afflicted and poor people, and they shall [k] take refuge in the name of Jehovah. 13 The [l] remnant of Israel shall [m] not do iniquity, [n] nor speak lies; neither shall a deceitful tongue be found in their mouth; for they shall [o] feed and lie down, and none shall make them afraid.

14 Sing, O daughter of Zion; [p] shout, O Israel; be glad and rejoice with all the heart, O daughter of Jerusalem. 15 Jehovah hath taken away thy judgments, he hath cast out thine enemy: the King of Israel, even Jehovah, is [q] in the midst of thee; thou shalt [r] not [5] fear evil any more. 16 In that day it shall be said to Jerusalem, [s] Fear thou not; [6] O Zion, let not thy hands be slack. 17 Jehovah thy God is [t] in the midst of thee, a [u] mighty one who will save; he will [v] rejoice over thee with joy; he will [7] rest in his love; he will joy over thee with singing. 18 [8] I will gather them that [x] sorrow for the solemn assembly, who were of thee; *to whom* the burden upon [9] her was a reproach. 19 Behold, at that time I will deal with all them that [y] afflict thee; and I will save that which is [z] lame, and gather that which was driven away; and I will make them a [a] praise and a name, whose [b] shame hath been in all the earth. 20 At that time will I [c] bring you in, and at that time will I gather you; for I will make you a [d] name and a praise among all the peoples of the earth, when I [10] [e] bring back your captivity before your eyes, saith Jehovah.

[a] ch. 1. 18
[b] Is. 19. 18; 57. 19
[c] ch. 2. 11; Ps. 22. 27; 86. 9; Hab. 2. 14
[d] Ps. 68. 31; Is. 11. 11; 18. 1, 7
[e] Is. 60. 6, 7
[f] Is. 45. 17; 54. 4; Joel 2. 26, 27
[g] Is. 2. 12; 5. 15
[h] Is. 11. 9; 56. 7; Ezek. 20. 40
[i] Is. 14. 30, 32; Zech. 13. 8, 9
[k] Is. 50. 10; Nah. 1. 7
[l] ch. 2. 7; Is. 10. 20–22; Mic. 4. 7
[m] ver. 5; Ps. 119. 3; Jer. 31. 33
[n] Zech. 8. 3, 16
[o] Is. 65. 10; Ezek. 34. 13–15
[p] Zech. 9. 9
[q] ver. 5; Ezek. 37. 26–28
[r] Is. 54. 14
[s] Is. 35. 3, 4
[t] ver. 5, 15
[u] Is. 63. 1
[v] Is. 62. 5
[x] Ps. 42. 2–4; Ezek. 9. 4, 6
[y] Is. 60. 14; Zech. 8. 23
[z] Ezek. 34. 16; Mic. 4. 6
[a] Is. 60. 18; 62. 7
[b] Ezek. 16. 27, 57
[c] Ezek. 37. 12, 21
[d] Dt. 26. 18, 19; Is. 56. 5; 66. 22
[e] ch. 2. 7; Jer. 29. 14; Joel 3. 1

[1] Heb. *lip.*
[2] Heb. *shoulder.*
[3] Or, *shall they bring my suppliants, even the daughter of my dispersed, for an offering unto me*
[4] Or, *them that exult in thy majesty*
[5] Another reading is *see.*
[6] Or, and to *Zion*
[7] Heb. *be silent.*
[8] Or, *They have been sorrowful for the solemn assembly which I took away from thee,* for *the lifting up of reproach against her*
[9] According to another reading, *thee.*
[10] Or, *return to*